TRUTH, FREEDOM OF SPEECH, & MODERN-DAY CENSORSHIP



INTERNATIONAL PRIVATE EXPERT MEETING
CO-SPONSORED BY
SUBSIDIUM-THE INTERNATIONAL CATHOLIC JURISTS FORUM
RALSTON COLLEGE, THE RUTH INSTITUTE, AVE MARIA SCHOOL OF LAW, CENTER FOR FAMILY AND HUMAN RIGHTS (C-FAM)

THURSDAY- SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 25-27, 2025

THE UNIVERSITY CLUB OF WASHINGTON DC

THE BEACON HOTEL & CORPORATE HEADQUARTERS

ARTIST: NIKOLAI GETMAN [FORMER GULAG PRISONER]
TITLE: 'IN THE NKVD'S DUNGEON,' THE GULAG COLLECTION
LOCATION: VICTIMS OF COMMUNISM MUSEUM

CONCEPT NOTE

The purpose of this meeting is to explore ways to defend, in law and the public sphere, both freedom of expression and the common good. In terms of some possible strategies we will consider:

- Defending **the concept of truth itself**, advocating for the right to express it, and articulating it.

- Studying, understanding and explaining the nature of the processes, patterns, and behaviours that have brought us to the point that **censorship is being promoted by global elites from large democracies**.

- Working to **expose the lie** that elites wish to protect people from misinformation, disinformation, and hate speech.

- **Breaking the walls of propaganda-induced social isolation, fear of ostracism and related self-censorship** provoked by fear of expressing one's thoughts on issues such as identity politics, political correctness, media and social mob agitation and control through various means (e.g., de-platforming, firings, lawfare suits, de-banking).

- **Nominating judges and electing officials** that demonstrate a respect for the Constitution.

- **Converting** those who are promoting censorship.

- **Setting up think tanks** that promote free speech**, critically evaluating censorship tools, and planning education seminars**, conferences, and small discussion groups.

LINK TO CONCEPT NOTE (LONG VERSION)

AGENDA

THURSDAY
SEPTEMBER 25, 2025
3:00 PM- 7:00 PM

3:00 PM — **GREETINGS & INTRODUCTORY INTERVENTION**

Stephen Blackwood
Censorship Today, Understanding the Challenges

3:30 PM — **PANEL I** — **THE FOUNDATIONS OF FREE SPEECH**

A. Truth and Freedom

Daniel Gallagher
The Philosophical Foundations of Free Speech

Robert Fastiggi
Judeo-Christian Foundations of Free Speech

B. Freedom and Authority

Douglas Farrow
Recognizing Authority

COFFEE BREAK

Rev. Piotr Mazurkiewicz
Authoritarianism

C. Law and the Common Good

Michal Gierycz
How Law Serves the Common Good, What it Means for Global Governance

D. Subsidiarity and Solidarity

Iain Benson
Origins and Contemporary Aspects

6:00 PM — **BREAK**

7:00 PM — **DINNER**

KEYNOTE

Russel Hittinger

AGENDA

FRIDAY
SEPTEMBER 26, 2025
7:30 AM to 7:00 PM

7:30 AM — **MASS**

Cathedral of St. Mathew
1725 Rhode Island Ave NW,
Washington, DC 20036

8:00 AM — **BREAKFAST**

9:00 AM

PANEL II

KEY THEMES

A. Historical Manifestations of Censorship

Carlos Casanova
The Philosophical Roots of Propaganda and Censorship in Communism

Robert Fastiggi
The Theological Roots of Censorship in the Catholic Church: Past (The Index) and Present

B. The State and Censorship

Gudrun Kugler
Between Truth and Taboo: A Catholic Politician's Experience in the Arena

C. Language, Law, Technology and Censorship

Iain Benson
Hate Speech as a Legal Category: Challenges and Controversies

Juan Carlos Riofrio
Technical Challenges in Testing Discriminatory Speech

DISCUSSION

11:00 AM TO 11:30 AM

COFEE BREAK

11:30 AM

D. Health and Censorship

Fulvio Di Blasi
COVID-19 Vaccinations and Censorship

E. Sex, Gender Ideology and Censorship

Jennifer Roback-Morse
Propaganda, Censorship and the Loss of Truth: Why the Sexual Revolution Needs Power and Propaganda

Rev. Paul Sullins
Censorship Regarding Abortion, Conversion Therapy, and Transgenderism

DISCUSSION

1:00 PM TO 2:00 PM

LUNCH

2:00 PM

PANEL III **KEY INTERNATIONAL DEVELOPMENTS**

A. Europe

Paul Diamond
Censorship in the UK: The Muslim Grooming Gangs as a Case Study

José Luis Bazán
Self-Censorship: Is Free Expression at Risk in the European Union?

B. Cuba

Jason Poblete
Beyond Silence: How Decades of Institutionalized Censorship in Cuba Reveals a Global Crisis of Rights

3:00 TO 3:30 PM — **COFFEE BREAK**

C. Africa

Marcela Szymanski
Censorship Concerning the Persecution and Genocide of Christians: Nigeria as a Case Study

D. The United Nations Organization

Stefano Gennarini
Censorship Regarding Faith, Family and Life: The Madness and Methodologies

Jane Adolphe
The Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration (GCM): The Depoliticization/Censorship Approach

6:00 PM — **BREAK AND OPEN DISCUSSION**

7:00 PM — **DINNER**

KEYNOTE

Aaron Kheriaty

AGENDA

SATURDAY
SEPTEMBER 27, 2025
7:30 AM- 12:00 PM

7:30 AM — **MASS** — **Cathedral of St. Mathew**

8:00 AM — **BREAKFAST**

9:00 AM — **PANEL IV** — **STRATEGY DISCUSSION**

MODERATOR — **Austin Ruse**

What are some strategies to counter the censorship problem of today?

Regarding the formation strategy to publish the conference proceedings, are other topics needed to be addressed? If so, which ones? Who should be approached to write them?

12:00 PM — **CLOSING REMARKS**